

For a time, the city-states of Italy were at peace. This allowed people to concentrate on more productive pursuits than fighting. Peace left everyone feeling better—and it was no doubt good for Ser Piero's business, too.

Ser Piero now turned his attention to Leonardo, who moved from his mother's home to his father's nearby estate. Most probably Leonardo moved because he was now old enough to begin a more

formal education. Unlike his mother, Leonardo's father could afford to pay for proper teaching. Here, Leonardo would spend the rest of his

childhood with other members of his father's family, including his uncle and grandfather. Leonardo's new stepmother, Albiera, could have made life difficult for him, because he was not one of her own children, but she didn't. Albiera was kind to Leonardo and made him feel at home.

